

Democracy and Political Values in Ukraine

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Paper prepared for presentation at the 17th Annual World Convention of the Association for the
Study of Nationalities at Columbia University, New York, NY, April 19-21, 2012

Abstract

This study examines democratic orientations and their determinants in post-Orange Ukraine from the perspective of a political culture theory. The research question is, to what extent is political culture in Ukraine supportive of democracy. This paper uses data from different waves of the Pew Global Attitudes surveys, the World Values Surveys, and the International Foundation for Electoral Systems surveys to examine public views towards democracy in Ukraine. The paper compares democratic values in Ukraine with those in Poland and Russia, two similar post-communist countries with differing political cultures and divergent trajectories of democratization. It also examines changes in the levels of pro-democratic attitudes in post-Orange Ukraine compared to the Orange and pre-Orange periods. Finally, this study implements multiple regression analysis of the determinants of democratic attitudes. The analysis shows limited effects of historical democratic legacies and Catholicism on pro-democracy views. With some exceptions, adherents of major parties do not differ significantly in terms of their degree of support for democracy. This study suggests that partially democratic and partially authoritarian political culture impedes the future prospects for consolidated democracy in Ukraine.

Democracy and Political Values in Ukraine

This paper examines the prospects for democracy in post-Orange Ukraine from a political culture perspective. Ukraine is a good case for analyzing democratic and undemocratic political values or culture. As a result of the “Orange Revolution” in 2004, when mass public protests prompted a reversal of the fraudulent presidential elections, it became the most democratic country in the post-Soviet region, with the exception of the Baltic states. For example, the Freedom House democracy index classified Ukraine as the only “free” post-Soviet country, excluding the Baltic states, every year from 2005 to 2009 (Freedom House, 2012). In this regard, Ukraine was considered variously as either a democratic outlier or a potential model to follow for semi-democratic or authoritarian post-Soviet states, such as Russia and Belarus. (See, for example, Myagkov, Ordeshook, and Shakin, 2009; Levitsky and Way, 2010).

However, the victory of Viktor Yanukovich in the 2010 presidential elections brought a reversal in the trajectory of democratization. For instance, since 2010 the Freedom House has classified Ukraine as “partly free,” putting this post-Soviet country into the same category it was in prior to the “Orange Revolution” (Freedom House, 2012). Although Yanukovich won democratic elections in 2010, he was involved in an attempt to gain power by falsifying the results of the 2004 presidential elections in his favor (See Lukinova, Myagkov, and Ordeshook, 2011; Myagkov, Ordeshook, and Shakin, 2009; Wilson, 2005). After the 2010 presidential elections, the Party of Regions established a coalition by employing quasi-legal means to change the parliamentary majority. The ruling coalition includes the Communist Party of Ukraine, a successor to the Ukrainian branch of the Communist Party of the Soviet Union, which was a totalitarian organization for most of its history. The Party of Regions won local elections in most Eastern, Southern, and Central regions in 2010, but these elections were less free and fair

compared to previous elections. A number of recent studies argue that post-Orange Ukraine under Yanukovych is in the process of a retreat from democracy towards an autocracy, and that political values, particularly in primarily Russian-speaking Eastern and Southern regions that overwhelmingly voted for Viktor Yanukovych, are authoritarian (See, for example, Kramer, Nurick, Wilson, Alterman, 2011; Kuzio, 2011; Menon and Motyl, 2011).

In addition to the victories of Viktor Yanukovych in the 2010 presidential contest and his Party of Regions in the local elections, strong votes for Svoboda in many Western Ukrainian regions in the 2010 local elections also raise questions regarding the future of a democracy and the strength of democratic values in Ukraine. Svoboda (Freedom), a radical nationalist party, which in addition to electoral politics advocated the use of non-democratic methods, became the dominant party in the regional councils in Galicia and one of the major oppositional parties on the national level. This party presents itself as an ideological successor to the Organization of Ukrainian Nationalists, which advanced a semi-totalitarian political program combining fascism and radical nationalism and employed terrorism for most of its existence in Ukraine during the 1930s and the 1940s. Svoboda has a significant chance to enter the national parliament in the 2012 parliamentary elections by clearing the 5% vote threshold on the party list ballot and/or winning seats in single-mandate districts, primarily in Galicia. A very limited number of previous studies has analyzed the rise of this radical nationalist party and its implications for the future of democracy in Ukraine (see, for instance, Shekhovtsov, 2011).

The research question is concerned with the extent to which political culture or values in Ukraine are supportive of a democratic political system. This study uses comparative and statistical analyses of several major surveys, such as the World Values Surveys, Pew Research

Center's Global Attitudes surveys, and the International Foundation for Electoral Systems (IFES) surveys to examine fundamental orientations towards major aspects of democracy in Ukraine.

Numerous previous studies have pointed out such factors as the level of economic development, civil society, political institutions (such as presidential or parliamentary systems), and international linkages and environments (such as integration with the European Union), that promote or hinder democracy in various countries, including Ukraine (see, for instance, Lai and Melkonian-Hoover, 2005; Przeworski, Alvarez, Cheibub, and Limongi, 2000; Levitsky and Way, 2010; Linz, 1990; Lipset, 1959; Lipset and Lakin, 2004). However, democracy also requires a supportive political culture or values, which involve fundamental orientations, beliefs, and norms (see, for example, Almond and Verba, 1965; Inglehart and Welzel, 2003; Lipset, 1994; Lipset and Lakin, 2004; Putnam, Leonardi, and Nanetti, 1993).

A number of major survey-based analyses have concluded that mass political values in pre-Orange Ukraine were generally supportive of democracy, and that they did not preclude emergence of a consolidated democracy (Gibson, 1996; Haerpfer, 2008; Reisinger, Miller, Hesli and Maher, 1994). However, a period of democratization soon after Ukraine's independence was followed by the emergence of a semi-authoritarian regime during the presidency of Leonid Kuchma. Previous studies generally presented the "Orange Revolution" in 2004 as a democratic breakthrough or a democratic revolution that turned Ukraine from a semi-autocracy into a democracy. Indeed, democracy was often regarded as the most likely future path for this post-Soviet state (see Aslund and McFaul, 2006; D'Anieri, 2005; Hale, 2006; Katchanovski, 2008; Kuzio, 2010; Motyl, 2008; Stepan, 2005; Way, 2005; Wilson, 2005).

Mass protest actions against falsification of the results of the 2004 presidential elections and the victory of Viktor Yushchenko in the repeat second round of the 2004 elections

were often cited as evidence of democratic values being held by Ukrainians. Particularly Western Ukraine, whose residents overwhelmingly voted for Yushchenko and actively participated in mass protest actions, was frequently regarded as a bastion of democracy. Some studies argued that a younger generation socialized in an independent Ukraine and whose members disproportionately participated in the “Orange Revolution” became the bearer of democratic political values. Stronger democratic values in Ukraine compared to Russia were a key factor explaining their diverging trajectories in terms of democratization (see Brudny and Finkel, 2011; Kuzio, 2010; Motyl, 2008; Nikolayenko, 2007).

However, some scholars argued that the “Orange Revolution” was not a revolution at all, but rather an evolutionary development that did not bring about fundamental changes in political values, formal and informal political institutions, and types of parties and leaders. Ukraine’s foreseeable future was more compatible with a semi-democratic political system than with a Western-type liberal democracy. Many studies that predicted relatively favorable prospects for democracy in Ukraine after the “Orange Revolution” ignored strong currents of undemocratic values that were shared to a certain extent even by political leaders and parties that branded themselves as democratic and pro-Western, such as Victor Yushchenko and his “Our Ukraine” bloc, and Yulia Tymoshenko and her Yulia Tymoshenko Bloc (BYuT). This was also the case with similar predictions concerning prospects for democracy in other post-Soviet countries, such as Georgia and Kyrgyzstan after the “color revolutions” in the mid-2000s and Russia under Boris Yeltsin in the 1990s (see Katchanovski, 1995; Tudoroiu, 2007).

Political values in Ukraine are expected to be less like those of the mostly democratic political cultures in post-communist countries such as Poland and more akin to semi-democratic or authoritarian values among the general public, political elites, and parties in such post-Soviet

countries as Russia or Georgia. Such hybrid semi-democratic/semi-authoritarian regimes combine multi-party systems and partly competitive elections with an authoritarian-leaning leader and a party of power. To maintain power, these leaders, such as Mikheil Saakashvili in Georgia and Vladimir Putin in Russia, and their parties rely not only on their popularity among the voters but also on administrative resources, including, for instance, government control over considerable parts of mass media.

Democratic, semi-democratic, or authoritarian political cultures are often linked to historical and religious legacies. For instance, the legacy of British colonial rule has had a positive impact on the levels of democracy present in various countries of the world (Lipset and Lakin, 2004). Similar lingering effects of legacies are likely to be found in Ukrainian regions that experienced various political systems prior to World War One and World War Two. These historical legacies include the relatively more democratic Austro-Hungarian rule before World War One in Galicia, Bukovyna, and Transcarpathia, as compared to the legacies of authoritarian rule present in the Russian Empire and the Ottoman Empire in other Ukrainian regions, and the relatively more democratic Czechoslovak, Polish, and Romanian rule in Western Ukraine (specifically Galicia, Bukovyna, Transcarpathia, and Volhynia) compared to totalitarian rule in Soviet Ukraine between World Wars One and Two (see for example, Birch, 2000; Katchanovski, 2006). However, the effect of these historical legacies on democratic culture in the various regions of Ukraine is likely to prove less significant than the effect on pro-nationalist/pro-Western vs. pro-Communist/pro-Russian values, considering that the democratic experience resulting from the Austro-Hungarian Empire and inter-war-Poland, Romania, and Czechoslovakia was generally relatively short in duration, and because participation of Ukraine

in elections and democratic parties was much more limited compared to the participation of Poles or Czechs.

Compared to Muslim countries, both Protestant and (since the last decades of the 20th century) Catholic countries have a much greater likelihood of being democratic (see Huntington 1991). Even the series of overthrows of longstanding authoritarian governments in 2011 in such Muslim countries as Egypt, Tunisia, and Libya, and the mass protest movements or violent rebellions against authoritarian regimes in several other countries, such as Yemen and Syria, did not alter this pattern. Moreover, prospects for consolidated liberal democracy in states such as Egypt, Tunisia, and Libya remain relatively low, as evidenced by strong popular backing for radical Islamist parties. Even the overthrow of dictatorships in Afghanistan and Iraq by military force and the relatively prolonged occupations of these countries by the United States with the support of some other major Western democracies, such as the United Kingdom, did not turn these countries into self-sustaining democracies, despite predictions to the contrary by many scholars and policy-makers in the West.

Western Christian religious legacies, compared to Muslim and Orthodox Christian legacies, tend to have positive effects on the democratization of post-communist states (Pop-Eleches, 2007). A similar effect of religious legacies can be expected in Ukraine, since the country has a significant Greek Catholic population, concentrated mostly in Galicia and Transcarpathia, while its other regions are predominantly Orthodox. However, this effect might be muted to a certain extent, because Greek Catholicism combines allegiance to the Vatican and the Pope with the rituals and traditions of Orthodox Christianity and because the Greek Catholic Church was banned in Soviet Ukraine from the end of the 1940s until the end of the 1980s.

In addition to the above-mentioned reasons, the effects of historical and religious legacies are diminished on a national level because the relatively more democratic historical legacies are generally limited to regions of Western Ukraine, whose population constitutes only about one-fifth of the total population of Ukraine. The Greek Catholic legacy is even more restricted according to region in Ukraine. But the impact of these elements of political culture is expected to be noticeable in comparisons of the levels of democratic attitudes in Ukraine with those of Russia and Poland. While tilting more towards Russia than Poland in terms of pro-democratic orientations, the pro-democratic orientations are likely to be stronger in Ukraine compared to Russia.

Previous studies have also pointed out the political salience of ethnic, language, and economic factors. These include, for instance, political differences between ethnic Ukrainians and a Russian minority, and Ukrainian and Russian-speakers (see, for example, Arel, 1995; Birch, 2000; Bloom and Shulman, 2011; Kuzio, 2011; Wilson, 2005). Many scholars have frequently described the party system in Ukraine in terms of dichotomous categories of democratic Orange parties, such as “Our Ukraine” (led by Victor Yushchenko and Batkivshchyna) “Fatherland” (led by Yulia Tymoshenko), and various undemocratic anti-Orange parties, such as the Party of Regions (led by Viktor Yanukovich) and the Communist Party (led by Petro Symonenko). The leaders of these parties (particularly Tymoshenko and Yanukovich) are presented as polar opposites when it comes to democracy (see, for example, Kuzio, 2011; Menon and Motyl, 2011).

However, the differences between Orange and anti-Orange parties in regards to democracy are not as significant as this dichotomy implies. For instance, the Party of Regions and the Yulia Tymoshenko Bloc, which became the most popular political forces in Ukraine

since the “Orange Revolution,” negotiated, prior to the 2010 presidential elections, a secret pact to form a joint coalition, eliminate direct elections of the president, and divide power between each other for a long period of time. As noted, the Party of Regions formed a ruling coalition with the Communist Party, which traces its origins and certain major elements of its ideology to the totalitarian Communist Party of the Soviet Union. There is certain evidence that the Yanukovich government bolstered Svoboda. For example, Svoboda leaders received disproportionately large amounts of time to present their views on several national television channels that were controlled by the Yanukovich government or government members.

Similarly, Yulia Tymoshenko’s Batkivshchyna, Yushchenko’s “Our Ukraine” party, Front zmin (Front of Change) led by Arsenii Yatseniuk, and several other parties presenting themselves as “national democrats” before the 2012 parliamentary elections formed, along with Svoboda, the Dictatorship Resistance Committee, and most of them agreed to cooperate during the elections. As noted, this radical nationalist party, which was originally called the Social-National Party, traces certain key elements of its ideology to the semi-totalitarian fascist Organization of Ukrainian Nationalists. Both the Party of Regions and Batkivshchyna represent the interests of oligarchs to a significant extent, and they are motivated less by their public ideologies than by rent-seeking accomplished with the help of government positions. Both Yanukovich and Tymoshenko were imprisoned on criminal charges, and there is evidence of their involvement in large-scale corruption.

Many Western policy-makers, specifically those from America, Britain, Canada, France, Germany, Sweden, and the European Union, as well as officials from other democratic countries and international organizations, expressed their support for Yulia Tymoshenko, declared her conviction as politically motivated, and demanded her release from prison. While

Tymoshenko's conviction in 2011 was partly politically motivated, there are also various pieces of evidence indicating her involvement in large-scale corruption and her possible involvement in other types of criminal activity. For example, in 2009 she ordered the signing of a long-term contract unfavorable to Ukraine for gas supplies from Russia without the required authorization of the entire government. US prosecutors concluded that Tymoshenko paid bribes to then prime-minister Pavlo Lazarenko, who was later imprisoned in the US for laundering this money, as a pay-back for granting her company a monopoly status for gas delivery in Ukraine. Tymoshenko has been, since the mid-1990s, the target of several criminal investigations involving the bribing of government officials, foreign currency smuggling, and tax nonpayment in Ukraine and Russia. She was also investigated in connection with the contract killings of rival businessmen in Donetsk in the mid-1990s.

While Western policies towards Ukraine, including those in connection with the Tymoshenko case, are often framed as support for democracy and democratic politicians, these policies are often driven not by such idealism as democracy promotion, but by realism involving perceived national interests. For this reason, the policies of the Western states are generally supportive of semi-democratic or authoritarian governments in pro-Western countries, while often being opposite concerning other countries with similar levels of democracy. For example, there are differing US policies concerning such semi-democratic countries as Georgia and Russia, Kosovo and Abkhazia, and Colombia and Venezuela. The same is true for such authoritarian states as Azerbaijan and Belarus, Bahrain and Yemen vs. Libya and Syria, Iran or Iraq under Saddam Hussein vs. Pakistan, and Saudi Arabia vs. Afghanistan under the Taliban. For the same reason, Western governments have opposed selective arrests or prosecutions for criminal charges of pro-Western opposition politicians, such as Yulia Tymoshenko and Yuri

Lutsenko in post-Orange Ukraine, but not similar selective arrests and criminal charges against pro-Russian opposition leaders, such as Evhen Kushnaryov and Borys Kolesnikov, after the “Orange Revolution.”

Methodology and Data

This study uses comparative and statistical analyses of data from the Pew Research Center’s Global Attitudes surveys, the World Values Surveys, and the IFES surveys to examine levels and determinants of support for democracy in Ukraine. The paper analyzes the levels of democratic and authoritarian attitudes in Ukraine compared to Poland and Russia, two neighboring Slavic post-communist countries, which demonstrated divergent trajectories in terms of democratization and whose political cultures are linked to different historical and religious legacies. Poland, which achieved democratic consolidation following the collapse of communism, is a Catholic country. It experienced a relatively more democratic system compared to the Russian Empire and the Soviet Union during, respectively, Austro-Hungarian and German imperial rule in large parts of its regions before World War One and during a significant part of the period after World War One and before World War Two. In contrast, Russia, which has experienced a reversal of its democratization since the beginning of the 2000s, is a predominantly Orthodox country with the relatively more authoritarian legacy of the Russian Empire and the totalitarian legacy of the Soviet Union.

All surveys analyzed in this study are based on nationally representative weighted samples.¹ The Pew Research Center’s Global Attitudes surveys, the World Values Surveys, and the IFES surveys provide different measures of democratic attitudes based on different types of questions concerning various aspects of democracy (see Pew, 2009, 2011; IFES, 2010, 2011;

World Values Survey, 2009). This is important, since reliance on a single type of question concerning democratic orientation can skew the results of an analysis. For example, direct questions about support for democracy do not necessarily provide exact measures of the level of democratic values, because respondents often attach different meanings to the term “democracy.” For instance, in the 2011 IFES survey in Ukraine, largely comparable percentages of respondents selected such economic statements as “everyone has work” (49%), “state support of pensioners” (32%), and “state support of those unable to work” (32%), compared to “protection of human rights” (59%), “freedom of speech” (35%), and “freedom to vote” (25%) to define meaning of democracy according to their views (IFES, 2011, p. 6).

While responses to direct questions regarding democracy might not be entirely valid as a measure of the overall levels of democratic values, such questions can be useful for comparing relative levels of democratic orientation in Ukraine and other countries, such as Poland and Russia, and their changes over time. The selected surveys also allow examination of changes in the levels of pro-democratic attitudes in post-Orange Ukraine compared to the Orange and pre-Orange periods, since attitudes are generally much less stable and much more malleable than values are. Different waves of the World Values Surveys asked the same questions in each of these three countries. The same applies to the Pew Global Attitudes surveys, with a certain variation of one question concerning a multiparty system. However, not all waves of these surveys were conducted in Poland.

Finally, this study uses multiple regression analysis of the determinants of democratic attitudes in the 2009 Pew Research Center’s Global Attitudes Survey conducted in Ukraine. The dependent variables include the following measures of views towards democracy: the democracy index, support for a change to a multiparty system, relative preference for a democracy vs. a

strong leader, and preference for democracy vs. a strong economy. The democracy index is derived by means of factor analysis based on six questions concerning the importance (for the respondent) of living in a country where one can openly say what they think and “can criticize the (state or government),” “honest elections are held regularly with a choice of at least two political parties,” “there is a judicial system that treats everyone in the same way,” “the military is under the control of civilian leaders,” “the media can report the news without (state or government) censorship,” and “you can practice your religion freely.” These questions form a single factor. The democracy index scale reliability coefficient (alpha) is acceptable (.77). In addition to standard OLS regressions, a logistic regression analysis is used for analysis of the determinants of preferences for democracy vs. a strong leader and a strong economy, since these measures are dummy variables.

Independent variables include such factors such as regional historical experience, defined by a Western region dummy variable (omitted), religion, political party preference, ethnicity, language, age, and income. The political party preference dummy variables measure support for the major political parties that were most popular at the time when the survey was conducted in 2009, such as the Party of Regions, the Yulia Tymoshenko Bloc, the Our Ukraine-People’s Self-Defense Bloc, and the Lytvyn Bloc. The Communist Party adherents dummy is the omitted variable in the regression models, because it is used as a yardstick for comparison of the effects of other parties. Because of significant increases in support for such parties as Svoboda and Front zmin have occurred since 2009, the survey did not differentiate adherents of these political parties. The regression models also control for the effects of such socio-demographic factors as gender, education level, and place of residence.

Main Results

The 2005-2006 wave of the World Values Surveys demonstrates that the absolute majority (81%) of the residents of Ukraine, excluding those who were undecided, expressed a favorable opinion towards a democratic political system soon after the “Orange Revolution.” The overall level of support for democracy in Ukraine was comparable in the mid-2000s to Poland (84%) and Russia (79%). However, in the 1995-97 and 1999 waves of this survey, Ukraine was more supportive of democracy than Russia was. The overall opposition to a democratic system in Ukraine (20%) was similar to the levels recorded in the mid and late 1990s (20 and 16%, respectively). The absolute majority of Ukrainian residents, like both their Polish and Russian counterparts, were opposed to having the army govern their countries. (Table 1).

[Table 1 and 2 about here]

However, Ukrainians in the mid-2000s were slightly more likely than Russians and much more likely than Poles were to back a political system with a strong leader who does not bother with parliament and elections (65, 57, and 31%, respectively). There was a comparable pattern in the second half of the 1990s (Table 1). The Pew Research Center’s Global Attitudes Surveys in 2009 demonstrated that respondents from Ukraine were much more supportive of “a leader with a strong hand” than a democratic form of government, compared to Poles. In comparison with Russia, the views of Ukrainians on this question were similar in 2011, and less democratic in 2009 but somewhat more democratic in spring 1991, 2002, and 2007 (see Table 2).

The Pew surveys show that Ukrainians expressed much lower support for a change to a multiparty system compared to Poles, and, to a somewhat lesser extent, compared to Russians. For example, in 2009, 36% of the respondents in Ukraine, 61% of those in Russia, and 81% of those in Poland approved or approved strongly such a change (Table 3). There was a partial

exception in spring 1991, when a somewhat greater percentage of Ukrainians than Russians (80% and 70%, respectively) backed a multiparty system. While the democracy index indicates pro-democracy attitudes on the part of the absolute majorities of Ukrainians, Russians, and Poles, the preferences become very different when a choice is given between a “strong economy” and “a good democracy.” Only 13% of Ukrainian and 16% of Russian respondents, compared to 40% of their Polish counterparts, express preference for the democracy (See Table 4).

[Table 3, 4 and 5 about here]

The IFES Surveys conducted in post-Orange Ukraine in 2010 and 2011 reveal that the majority of the respondents did not consider Ukraine a democracy. Similar results on this question were reported during the “Orange Revolution” (See IFES, 2010, 2011). As in the World Values Surveys and Pew surveys, the IFES surveys show relative support for a democratic form of government over a non-democratic one on a direct question, but a different pattern of attitudes when choices involving trade-offs between the democratic rights of citizens and economic development or maintenance of order are introduced (Table 5).

The regression analysis of the 2009 Pew Research Center’s Global Attitudes Survey shows that determinants of democratic attitudes in Ukraine often varied depending upon the specific measure of these attitudes being used. For example, the average respondent in the South scored much lower on the democracy index than the average respondent in historically Western Ukraine, keeping other factors constant. But this regional pattern was reversed in the support for democracy vs. a strong leader question. The respondents in the East and the Center were much less likely than their counterparts in the historical West were to express preference for democracy as opposed to a strong economy. While these effects were statistically significant, the regional variables were statistically insignificant in all other cases (See Table 6).

[Table 6 about here]

Catholics scored higher on the democracy index, and they are more supportive of the change to a multiparty system. Russian-speakers expressed greater approval of the multiparty system compared to Ukrainian-speakers, when other factors are held constant in the regression analysis. These effects were statistically significant at the 5% level. Age was associated negatively with backing change to the multiparty system after the collapse of the Soviet one-party communist system and with preference to democracy over a strong leader. While the effects of age are statistically significant in these cases, the magnitude of the impact of age on these two measures of democratic attitudes was small. Education level was positively associated with approval of the change to a multiparty system (Table 6). Income was a statistically insignificant determinant of the attitudes towards democracy when this variable was included in the regression models.²

Supporters of the Our Ukraine-People's Self-Defense Bloc expressed significantly greater approval of the change to a multiparty system and preference for democracy relative to economy. These effects were statistically significant at the .1% level. However, the Our Ukraine-People's Self-Defense Bloc was supported at the time of the 2009 Pew survey by only 4% of the residents of Ukraine, excluding undecided respondents. Adherents of other major parties and electoral blocs, such as the Party of Regions, the Yulia Tymoshenko Bloc, and the Lytvyn Bloc, did not differ significantly from Communist Party-likely voters on these and other measure of democratic attitudes. (See Table 6).

Conclusion

Although the “Orange Revolution” in Ukraine was generally regarded as a democratic breakthrough that created favorable conditions for democracy in the nation, this assessment was quickly reversed after Victor Yanukovich came to power as a result of the 2010 presidential elections. This study contributes to the analysis of the seemingly shifting prospects for democracy in Ukraine by focusing on the analysis of democratic and undemocratic values or political culture, which is an important but understudied factor of democracy.

The analysis of the World Values Surveys, the Pew Global Attitudes surveys, and the IFES surveys demonstrates that democratic political culture has not become deeply entrenched in Ukraine. Although the majority of Ukrainians express high levels of support for democracy in response to direct questions, these seemingly democratic attitudes are, to a significant extent, shallow. When given an alternative, the majority of respondents express preference for a strong leader or a strong economy over a democratic system and disapprove of the change to a multiparty system following the break-up of the Soviet Union.

The basic orientations towards democracy have not changed radically since the “Orange Revolution” and in post-Orange Ukraine, compared to the pre-Orange era. The most notable exception is spring 1991, shortly before the collapse of the Soviet communism and independence of Ukraine, but such anomalous attitudes can be attributed to the support of various forms of democratization at that time by both the nationalist opposition and the reformist Communist Party leadership led by Mikhail Gorbachev. Comparative analysis shows that respondents in Ukraine are closer to Russia than to Poland on many measures of democratic attitudes, and their values are generally much less democratic compared to those held in Poland.

There are regional differences in attitudes towards certain dimensions of democracy. These can be attributed to differences in political culture due to distinct historical legacies in

Western Ukraine compared to other parts of Ukraine. However, statistical analysis offers only partial empirical support for the notion of a relatively more democratic culture in Western Ukraine. The same applies to the relatively more democratic attitudes of Catholics compared to Orthodox Christians in Ukraine. These differences, which are also limited to certain measures of democratic orientations, can be linked to distinct religious legacies.

While Ukrainian politics are often presented as being primarily characterized by the contrasts between democratic Orange parties and leaders and their undemocratic anti-Orange counterparts, the analysis of the 2009 Pew survey data shows that supporters of major parties on both sides of the political spectrum, in particular, the Yulia Tymoshenko Bloc and the Party of Regions, do not differ significantly in terms of their attitudes towards democracy compared to those of the Communist Party. The Our Ukraine-People's Self-Defense Bloc is the partial exception to this pattern, but its public support had largely collapsed by the end of the Orange period when its leader, Viktor Yushchenko, was President of Ukraine.

This study suggests *ceteris paribus* that the prospects for democracy in Ukraine are impeded by partially democratic and partially authoritarian values. This feature of the nation's political culture makes the future of Ukraine more compatible with a semi-democratic hybrid political system, such as that which emerged in such countries as post-Soviet Russia, than with a consolidated democracy, such as the type that developed in post-communist Poland. However, although political culture evolves gradually over generations, it is only one among a number of important factors of democracy. Other factors, which can change over a relatively short period of time (for example, the EU offering Ukraine a real prospect for membership), can still make consolidated democracy in Ukraine possible, even though this is not very likely to happen.

Table 1. Democratic and non-democratic attitudes in Ukraine, Russia, and Poland in 1995-2006, World Values Surveys

	1995-1997*		1999			2005-2006		
	Ukraine	Russia	Ukraine	Russia	Poland	Ukraine	Russia	Poland
<i>Having a democratic political system</i>								
Very good	20	6	22	8	23	37	24	23
Fairly good	60	52	63	55	60	44	55	61
Fairly bad	14	31	11	29	13	15	16	14
Very bad	6	11	5	8	3	5	5	2
Total, %	100	100	100	100	100	100	100	100
N	1935	1591	903	1884	950	818	1694	864
<i>Having a strong leader who does not have to bother with parliament and elections</i>								
Very good	22	17	25	15	7	28	20	7
Fairly good	33	34	35	34	15	37	37	24
Bad	33	35	29	36	42	22	32	43
Very bad	13	14	12	15	36	14	12	26
Total, %	100	100	100	100	100	100	100	100
N	1994	1725	947	2066	984	802	1673	883
<i>Having the army rule</i>								
Very good	3	4	3	3	2	5	4	2
Fairly good	9	17	10	16	15	18	12	19
Fairly bad	40	45	39	48	42	31	46	44
Very bad	49	34	48	33	41	46	39	35
Total, %	100	100	100	100	100	100	100	100
N	2078	1703	941	2089	969	806	1710	874

Note: * Survey of Poland is not available. Source: World Values Survey (2009).

Table 2. Preferences for democratic form of government vs. strong leader in Ukraine, Russia, and Poland in 1991-2011, Pew Research Center's Global Attitudes Surveys, %

	1991*		2002			2007			2009			2011*	
	Ukraine	Russia	Ukraine	Russia	Poland	Ukraine	Russia	Poland	Ukraine	Russia	Poland	Ukraine	Russia
Democratic form of government	66	57	32	23	48	42	30	63	22	33	62	33	36
Strong leader	34	43	68	77	52	58	70	37	78	67	38	67	64
Total, %	100	100	100	100	100	100	100	100	100	100	100	100	100
N	510	1011	490	912	420	460	892	459	890	890	911	900	890

Note: * Survey of Poland is not available. Source: Pew Research Center's Global Attitudes Project. 2012. Pew Research Center, <http://www.pewglobal.org>.

Table 3. Views of change to a multiparty system in Ukraine, Russia, and Poland in 1991- 2011, Pew Research Center's Global Attitudes Surveys, %

	1991			2009			2011*	
	Ukraine	Russia	Poland	Ukraine	Russia	Poland	Ukraine	Russia
Strongly approve	23	24	27	11	14	29	7	16
Approve	57	46	51	25	47	52	34	45
Disapprove	16	22	15	45	31	14	43	31
Strongly disapprove	3	8	7	20	9	5	16	8
Total, %	100	100	100	100	100	100	100	100
N	527	977	1257	852	880	870	860	830

Note: * Survey of Poland is not available. Source: Pew Research Center's Global Attitudes Project. 2012. Pew Research Center, <http://www.pewglobal.org>.

Table 4. Attitudes towards democracy in Ukraine, Russia, and Poland, the 2009 Pew Research Center's Global Attitudes Survey, %

	Ukraine	Russia	Poland
<i>Democracy Index</i>			
Strongly pro-democracy	48	38	55
Moderately pro-democracy	46	56	42
Moderately anti-democracy	6	6	3
Strongly anti-democracy	0	1	0
Total, %	100	100	100
N	825	835	857
<i>If you had to choose between a good democracy or a strong economy, which would you say is more important?</i>			
A good democracy	13	16	40
A strong economy	87	84	60
Total, %	100	100	100
N	901	927	902

Source: Pew Research Center's Global Attitudes Project. 2012. Pew Research Center, <http://www.pewglobal.org>.

Table 5. Attitudes towards democracy in post-Orange Ukraine, IFES Surveys, %

	2010	2011
<i>Is Ukraine a democracy?</i>		
Yes	31	27
No	51	56
Both	16	18
Total, %	100	100
N	1215	1182
<i>Agree most with the statement</i>		
Democracy is preferable to any other form of government	38	41
In certain situations, a non-democratic government can be preferable	30	21
To people like me, it doesn't matter what form of government we have	32	38
Total, %	100	100
N	1276	1303
<i>Agree most with the statement</i>		
It should be a priority for Ukraine to pursue economic development, even if it means foregoing some democratic rights	58	60
Ukraine's priority should be to maintain democratic rights for its citizens, even if this means the economy develops slowly	42	40
Total, %	100	100
N	1185	1167
<i>It is more important that political leaders maintain order than protect democratic rights of citizens</i>		
Strongly agree	17	
Somewhat agree	32	
Somewhat disagree	36	
Strongly disagree	14	
Total, %	100	
N	1154	

Source: IFES (2010), IFES (2011).

Table 6. Determinants of democratic attitudes in Ukraine, the 2009 Pew Research Center's Global Attitudes Survey

	OLS Regressions				Logistic Regressions	
	Democracy Index		Change to multiparty system		Democracy vs. strong leader	Democracy vs. economy
	Regression coefficients	Standard Error	Regression coefficients	Standard Error	Odds ratios	Odds ratios
Center	.054	.063	.010	.099	1.483	.457*
South	-.254***	.079	.077	.123	2.095*	1.241
East	.062	.073	-.059	.113	.929	.421*
Urban	-.072	.046	-.035	.071	1.414	.852
Ethnic Russian	.033	.059	-.024	.091	.858	.559
Other ethnic minority	.119	.146	-.318	.227	.714	.266
Catholic	.157*	.072	.269*	.112	1.283	.938
Other religion	.269*	.131	.290	.204	1.798	1.929
Non-religious	-.100	.058	-.176	.090	.749	.729
Russian language	-.003	.053	.175*	.083	1.089	.920
Male	-.009	.039	.189**	.061	1.223	1.130
BYuT	.020	.068	.019	.106	.843	1.618
Our Ukraine-People's Self-Defense Bloc	-.074	.109	.581***	.169	2.004	4.481***
Lytvyn Bloc	-.166	.124	-.034	.193	.943	2.128
Party of Regions	.027	.061	.019	.094	.892	1.334
Other party	.020	.089	.305*	.138	1.390	2.765*
No party	-.082	.057	-.098	.089	1.061	1.385
Age	-.001	.001	-.008***	.002	.986**	.989
Education	.009	.011	.059***	.017	1.059	1.029
Constant	3.356***	.118	2.069***	.184	.194*	.229*
Adjusted R square/ Nagelkerke R square	.051		.110		.074	.117
N	822		848		890	898

Note: * Significant at the .05 level; ** significant at the .01 level, *** significant at the .001 level.

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Notes

¹ “Don’t know” and “refused” responses are excluded from the analysis to make comparison more straightforward.

² Because the number of observations in the regression models becomes much smaller when income is included, this variable was omitted from the rest of the regression analysis.